

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

MARKET OPEN

August 03, 2026 | 10:12 AM ET

15 setups identified | 6 A-Grade | 4 B-Grade | 5 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (6)	B - Strong Setup (4)	C - Watch List (5)
ATKR	FOSL	AUTL
BOW	NPK	IRWD
MCS	BXC	DQ
LIND	LIFE	AXTI
CDNA		TIC
ANIK		

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	ATKR	Atkore Inc.	Electrical Infrac	\$93.43	+28.1%	\$3.1B	31M	+22.2	100%	Strong earnings beat t
A	BOW	Bowhead Specialt	Specialty Insuran	\$33.75	+10.3%	\$1.1B	31M	+39.8	97%	Earnings beat today dr
A	MCS	Marcus Corporati	Entertainment Rec	\$32.13	+10.4%	\$1.0B	22M	+82.9	99%	Technical breakout to
A	LIND	Lindblad Expedit	Luxury Travel	\$34.07	+15.2%	\$2.2B	49M	+85.8	99%	Strong earnings beat t
A	CDNA	CareDx, Inc.	Transplant Diagno	\$47.88	+9.5%	\$2.5B	49M	+123.2	99%	Post-earnings follow-t
A	ANIK	Anika Therapeuti	Orthopedic Therap	\$20.55	+6.6%	\$0.3B	11M	+36.0	98%	Post-earnings follow-t
B	FOSL	Fossil Group, In	Consumer Turnarou	\$5.83	+17.8%	\$0.3B	48M	+29.1	100%	Pre-earnings speculati
B	NPK	National Presto	Defense / Aerospa	\$132.50	+9.1%	\$0.9B	5M	-5.2	88%	Technical breakout on
B	BXC	Bluelinx Holding	Building Products	\$57.68	+6.4%	\$0.5B	6M	+13.3	66%	Pre-earnings positioni
B	LIFE	Ethos Technologi	InsurTech	\$22.35	+9.4%	\$2.1B	30M	+9.5	69%	Earnings beat today dr
C	AUTL	Autolus Therapeu	CAR-T Biotech	\$1.86	+24.9%	\$0.5B	34M	+13.3	74%	Pre-earnings speculati
C	IRWD	Ironwood Pharmac	GI Therapeutics	\$4.49	+6.3%	\$0.7B	135M	-7.3	78%	Pre-earnings positioni
C	DQ	DAQO New Energy	Solar Polysilicon	\$13.69	+12.4%	\$0.9B	43M	-36.6	37%	Likely a short-coverin
C	AXTI	AXT Inc	Substrate Materia	\$64.71	+7.1%	\$4.2B	59M	-44.2	45%	Likely a relief bounce
C	TIC	TIC Solutions, I	Specialty Busines	\$7.74	+6.0%	\$1.7B	97M	-21.7	52%	Pre-earnings positioni

ATKR

Atkore Inc.

\$93.43

+28.06%

RS vs SPY: +22.2%

A BREAKOUT

\$3.1B Cap | 31M Float

Electrical Equipment & Parts | Theme: Electrical Infrastructure | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 8.38 | Vol: 71.58x | RS/SPY: +22.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$93.43
Day Change	+28.06%
Mkt Cap	\$3.15B
Float	31M sh
RS vs SPY	+22.2%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	8.38
Vol vs Avg	71.58x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Strong earnings beat today driving 28% surge - stock within 0.2% of 52W high. Forward catalyst: sustained infrastructure build-out demand from reshoring/data center construction over next 6-12 months, with next quarterly print in November to confirm margin trajectory.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Atkore manufactures electrical conduit, cable management systems, and safety infrastructure for construction and energy markets. Leader in a fragmented category benefiting from secular data center and industrial construction demand.
FACTOR & THEME
Reshoring and AI infrastructure build-out are primary tailwinds - electrical infrastructure is a direct derivative of data center CapEx acceleration. Theme momentum remains strong but cyclical; construction PMI and CapEx spending are key lead indicators.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$93.43 on vol >71x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Explosive 71.6x volume today signals institutional block accumulation on the earnings beat. Float is tight at 30.7M; rotation implies significant new institutional interest. No insider buying in the last 90 days, suggesting insiders may have been in blackout ahead of this print.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Just reported today - consensus and beat/miss details not yet available in this feed. Historical context: stock was range-bound for weeks before this print, suggesting the market was positioned cautiously.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$85 breakout pivot, or if next-quarter guidance (November print) indicates demand softening in non-residential construction or data center spend.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 8.38 indicates this was NOT a textbook consolidation - the stock was volatile heading into earnings, raising the risk this is a one-day pop rather than a durable re-rating. However, the combination of RS line at new high, extreme institutional volume, proximity to 52W high, and a clear forward catalyst path (infrastructure demand + next earnings in Nov) make this a high-conviction follow-through candidate if it holds the breakout level. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$93.43 on vol >71x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 71.58x



BOW

Bowhead Specialty Holdings Inc.

\$33.75

+10.33%

RS vs SPY: +39.8%

A BREAKOUT

\$1.1B Cap | 31M Float

Insurance - Property & Casualty | Theme: Specialty Insurance | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 3.71 | Vol: 9.88x | RS/SPY: +39.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$33.75
Day Change	+10.33%
Mkt Cap	\$1.11B
Float	31M sh
RS vs SPY	+39.8%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	3.71
Vol vs Avg	9.88x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings beat today driving breakout within 3% of 52W high. Forward catalyst (High impact): specialty insurance sector re-rating on hard-market pricing power; next print in early November will be critical to confirm underwriting margin expansion and reserve adequacy amid elevated catastrophe losses industry-wide.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Bowhead underwrites specialty property & casualty insurance for niche, high-barrier segments including environmental, construction defect, and excess casualty. Positioned as a disciplined underwriter in a hardening rate environment.
FACTOR & THEME
Hard insurance market cycle is the primary tailwind - commercial P&C rates up double-digits YoY, with reinsurance pricing also supportive. Financials sector momentum is strong (+1.8% vs SPY this week), and BOW's RS of +39.8 vs SPY signals it's a leader within the sector.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$33.75 on vol >9.8x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 9.88x average indicates heavy institutional buying on the earnings release. RS line at new high confirms this is a true leader, not a laggard catching up. Float of 30.8M is manageable; incremental demand from growth-oriented insurance allocators could sustain the move. No insider buying in the last 90 days.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Just reported today - specific EPS/revenue consensus not available in this feed. The 10.3% gap-up suggests a material beat and/or guidance raise.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$31.50 prior consolidation high, or if next earnings (early Nov) reveals reserve deterioration or loss-ratio expansion that contradicts the hard-market narrative.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: sector rotation risk - Financials are leading this week, but if macro pivots risk-off or long-duration rates fall sharply, specialty insurers can give back gains quickly. However, the setup checks all boxes: RS line new high, extreme volume, prox_52w 96.9, strong sector tailwind, and a clear forward catalyst (next earnings + hard-market cycle). Sector boost (+0.5 grade) applies, reinforcing the A. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$33.75 on vol >9.8x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 9.88x



MCS

Marcus Corporation (The)

\$32.13

+10.41%

RS vs SPY: +82.9%

A BREAKOUT

\$1.0B Cap | 22M Float

Entertainment | Theme: Entertainment Recovery | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 9.16 | Vol: 3.40x | RS/SPY: +82.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 88D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$32.13
Day Change	+10.41%
Mkt Cap	\$0.99B
Float	22M sh
RS vs SPY	+82.9%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	9.16
Vol vs Avg	3.40x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Technical breakout to within 0.6% of 52W high on strong volume, likely driven by continued box-office recovery and hotel/resort demand strength. Forward catalyst (Medium impact): next earnings in late October will test whether theater attendance and leisure spending momentum is durable through the fall; any upside guidance revision would extend the move.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Marcus operates movie theaters and hotels/resorts across the U.S., with theaters representing ~60% of EBITDA. The company is a regional leader benefiting from post-pandemic normalization in out-of-home entertainment and travel.
FACTOR & THEME
Consumer recovery and discretionary spending normalization are the core themes. Summer box office trends and hotel occupancy rates are lead indicators. Theme momentum is mixed - consumer spending is solid but slowing at the margin; any macro weakness hits discretionary first.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$32.13 on vol >3.4x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 3.4x average is solid but not explosive, suggesting a mix of institutional accumulation and momentum chasers. RS line at new high and RS vs SPY of +82.9 confirm this is an institutional-quality leader. Float is tight at 22.3M, which amplifies moves. No insider buying in the last 90 days.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 88D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next earnings scheduled for October 30. Consensus not available in this feed. MCS has a history of volatile prints given the cyclical nature of theaters and lodging; beat/miss history and guidance commentary will be critical.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$29.50 consolidation breakout level, or if box-office data or hotel industry metrics soften meaningfully ahead of the October 30 print.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 9.16 indicates high volatility heading into this breakout, not the tight consolidation ideal for sustained follow-through. The RS line new high and extreme +82.9 RS vs SPY are powerful, but the next catalyst is 88 days away - a long time to hold without a near-term re-rating event. The consumer discretionary sector is lagging (+0.2% vs SPY), a headwind. However, technical quality and leadership status earn the A grade. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$32.13 on vol >3.4x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.40x



LIND

Lindblad Expeditions Holdings I

\$34.07

+15.18%

RS vs SPY: +85.8%

A BREAKOUT

\$2.2B Cap | 49M Float

Travel Services | Theme: Luxury Travel | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 6.02 | Vol: 2.64x | RS/SPY: +85.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$34.07
Day Change	+15.18%
Mkt Cap	\$2.23B
Float	49M sh
RS vs SPY	+85.8%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	6.02
Vol vs Avg	2.64x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Strong earnings beat today driving 15% surge to within 1.2% of 52W high, likely driven by robust expedition cruise bookings and pricing power in the luxury travel segment. Forward catalyst (High impact): next print (likely November) will test whether demand momentum sustains into 2027 bookings and whether the company can maintain premium pricing in a slowing consumer environment.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Lindblad operates small-ship expedition cruises to remote destinations (Antarctica, Galápagos, Arctic), often in partnership with National Geographic. Premium-priced, experience-driven travel with high customer loyalty and barriers to entry.
FACTOR & THEME
Luxury consumer resilience is the core theme - high-net-worth individuals continue to prioritize experiential travel. Consumer Discretionary sector is flat this week (+0.2% vs SPY), so LIND's +85.8 RS indicates it's a true outlier. Tailwind is durable but concentrated in the top income quartile.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$34.07 on vol >2.6x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 2.64x average is solid, indicating institutional participation on the earnings beat. RS line at new high and RS of +85.8 confirm leadership status. Float of 49.4M is moderate; incremental demand from thematic travel/leisure funds could sustain momentum. No insider buying in the last 90 days.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Just reported today - specific EPS/revenue consensus not available in this feed. The 15% gap-up suggests a significant beat and likely upbeat forward guidance on bookings.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$30.50 prior resistance level, or if next earnings reveals slowing bookings or discounting pressure that contradicts the luxury-resilience narrative.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 6.02 indicates choppy consolidation, not a textbook coil. Consumer Discretionary sector is lagging, and LIND is a high-beta play on the luxury consumer - any macro deterioration hits this fast. However, the combination of earnings beat today, RS line new high, extreme RS vs SPY, and proximity to 52W high make this a credible breakout. Forward catalyst is the next print, ~90 days out. Conviction: Medium-High.
Signal: Close above \$34.07 on vol >2.6x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.64x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$47.88
Day Change	+9.53%
Mkt Cap	\$2.48B
Float	49M sh
RS vs SPY	+123.2%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	6.22
Vol vs Avg	2.61x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Post-earnings follow-through (reported July 30) driving continued breakout within 1.3% of 52W high, likely on strong transplant-monitoring test volume and reimbursement momentum. Forward catalyst (Medium-High impact): CMS coverage decisions for AlloSure and next earnings (likely late October) will test whether volume growth and margin expansion are sustainable.
BUSINESS & POSITION
CareDx provides precision medicine solutions for transplant patients, including AlloSure (cell-free DNA test for organ rejection monitoring). Category leader in a high-barrier, reimbursement-driven market with durable competitive moats.
FACTOR & THEME
Precision medicine and diagnostics innovation are secular tailwinds. AlloSure adoption is expanding post-CMS coverage; incremental payer expansion and label extensions (e.g., heart transplant) are growth drivers. Theme momentum is strong and non-cyclical.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$47.88 on vol >2.6x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 2.61x average indicates sustained institutional buying post-earnings. RS line at new high and RS of +123.2 vs SPY - the strongest in this cohort - confirm this is an institutional-quality leader. Float of 49.3M is moderate. No insider buying in the last 90 days.
EARNINGS
REPORTED
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reported July 30 (4 days ago). Consensus EPS/revenue not available in this feed, but the 9.5% post-earnings follow-through and RS line new high suggest a material beat and/or guidance raise.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$43.50 post-earnings consolidation low, or if CMS/payer reimbursement decisions turn adverse or competitive threats (Natera, CareDx rivals) gain share.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 6.22 indicates volatility in the consolidation, not a tight coil. Also, the earnings catalyst is now 4 days old - risk of exhaustion if no incremental news emerges. However, the RS of +123.2 is extraordinary, RS line is at new high, and the stock is within 1.3% of 52W high. The forward catalyst path (CMS decisions, next earnings in ~90 days) is durable. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$47.88 on vol >2.6x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.61x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$20.55
Day Change	+6.59%
Mkt Cap	\$0.28B
Float	11M sh
RS vs SPY	+36.0%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	7.02
Vol vs Avg	3.22x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS

Catalyst / Today's Driver

Post-earnings follow-through (reported July 29) driving breakout within 1.9% of 52W high, likely on strong sales of joint-preservation and regenerative products. Forward catalyst (Medium impact): next earnings (likely late October) and any FDA label expansions or partnership announcements for its hyaluronic acid platform.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Anika develops and commercializes therapeutic products for tissue protection, healing, and repair, primarily in orthopedics (osteoarthritis, sports medicine). Leader in hyaluronic acid-based treatments with a growing regenerative medicine portfolio.

Factor & Theme

Orthopedic and regenerative medicine demand is a steady, non-cyclical tailwind driven by aging demographics and sports medicine growth. Theme momentum is moderate - not a hot sector, but fundamentally sound.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$20.55 on vol >3.2x of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume at 3.22x average indicates institutional accumulation post-earnings. RS line at new high and RS of +36.0 confirm leadership within the small-cap healthcare space. Float is very tight at 11.3M, amplifying moves on incremental demand. No insider buying in the last 90 days.

EARNINGS

Reported

Earnings Context

Reported July 29 (5 days ago). Consensus details not available, but the 6.6% follow-through and RS line new high suggest a beat and/or positive guidance.

KEY RISK

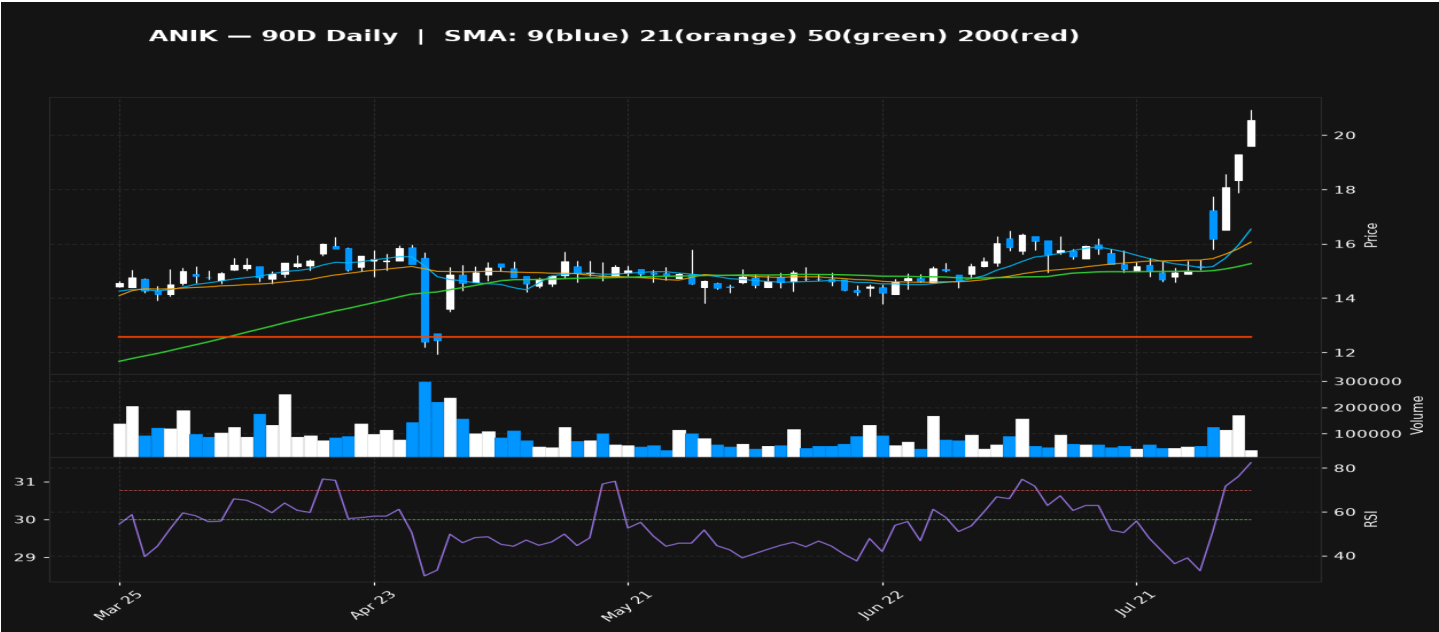
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$18.50 post-earnings consolidation low, or if next earnings reveals product-mix deterioration or pricing pressure in the orthopedic channel.

ANALYSIS

Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight of 7.02 indicates choppy consolidation, and the earnings catalyst is now 5 days old - risk of exhaustion if no fresh news emerges. However, the tight float (11.3M), RS line new high, proximity to 52W high, and durable orthopedic demand theme make this a credible institutional setup. Forward catalyst is the next print in ~90 days. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$20.55 on vol >3.2x of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 3.22x



FOSL

Fossil Group, Inc.

\$5.83

+17.78%

RS vs SPY: +29.1%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.3B Cap | 48M Float

Footwear & Accessories | Theme: Consumer Turnaround | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 7.33 | Vol: 5.86x | RS/SPY: +29.1% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 9D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$5.83
Day Change	+17.78%
Mkt Cap	\$0.34B
Float	48M sh
RS vs SPY	+29.1%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	7.33
Vol vs Avg	5.86x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Pre-earnings speculation driving 17.8% surge to within 0.2% of 52W high, likely on hopes for a turnaround or restructuring update. Forward catalyst (High impact, High risk): earnings on August 12 will be make-or-break - any beat or positive guidance on brand refresh/smartwatch pivot could extend the move; a miss or dilutive capital raise kills it.
Business & Position
Fossil designs and distributes watches, leather goods, and accessories. The company is in turnaround mode, pivoting from traditional watches to smartwatches and lifestyle accessories amid secular headwinds in the watch category.
Factor & Theme
Consumer discretionary recovery is the broad theme, but Fossil faces structural headwinds (smartphone displacement of watches). The +17.8% move is speculative positioning ahead of earnings, not a durable thematic tailwind.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$5.83 on vol >5.8x of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume at 5.86x average suggests a mix of short-covering and speculative accumulation ahead of earnings. RS line is NOT at new high, which downgrades conviction - this is a catch-up move, not leadership. Float of 48.5M is moderate. No insider buying in the last 90 days, a red flag given the turnaround context.
Earnings
Earnings in 9D
Earnings Context
Earnings scheduled for August 12 (9 days). Consensus not available in this feed. Fossil has a history of volatile, often disappointing prints - the market is clearly positioning for a potential positive surprise, but the risk of a miss is high.
Key Risk
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$5.00 prior resistance level, or if August 12 earnings disappoint or reveal continued brand erosion/margin pressure.
Analysis
Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line is NOT at new high - this is not a leader, it's a speculative turnaround play. The base_tight of 7.33 indicates volatility, and the lack of insider buying is a red flag. The setup is entirely driven by pre-earnings speculation 9 days out, with binary risk. However, the proximity to 52W high (99.8) and volume surge earn it a B grade as a high-risk/high-reward event trade, not a follow-through position. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$5.83 on vol >5.8x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 5.86x



NPK

National Presto Industries, Inc

\$132.50

+9.13%

RS vs SPY: -5.2%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.9B Cap | 5M Float

Aerospace & Defense | Theme: Defense / Aerospace | 52W Hi: 88% | Base Tight: 3.56 | Vol: 8.71x | RS/SPY: -5.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 81D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$132.50
Day Change	+9.13%
Mkt Cap	\$0.95B
Float	5M sh
RS vs SPY	-5.2%
52W Hi Prox	88%
Base Tight	3.56
Vol vs Avg	8.71x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Technical breakout on strong volume (8.71x), likely driven by defense sector rotation or a contract announcement. Forward catalyst (Medium impact): defense budget authorization cycles and next earnings on October 23 will test whether the company's ammunition and defense electronics segments are seeing sustained demand from DoD/allied procurement.

BUSINESS & POSITION

National Presto operates in two segments: small appliances (consumer) and defense (ammunition, fuses, precision cartridge cases). Defense represents the majority of operating income and is driven by government contracts.

FACTOR & THEME

Defense spending is a secular tailwind (geopolitical tensions, NATO rearmament, U.S. defense budget growth). However, NPK is a small, underfollowed defense play with limited scalability vs. prime contractors. Theme momentum is strong but NPK's RS of -5.2 vs SPY suggests it's lagging the sector.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$132.50 on vol >8.7x of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume at 8.71x average indicates a likely contract win or rumor driving institutional interest. RS line is NOT at new high, and RS vs SPY is negative - this is not a leader. Float is very tight at 4.8M, which amplifies moves but also raises liquidity risk. No insider buying in the last 90 days.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 81D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next earnings scheduled for October 23 (81 days). Consensus not available. NPK prints are infrequent and volatile; defense contract timing drives results.

KEY RISK

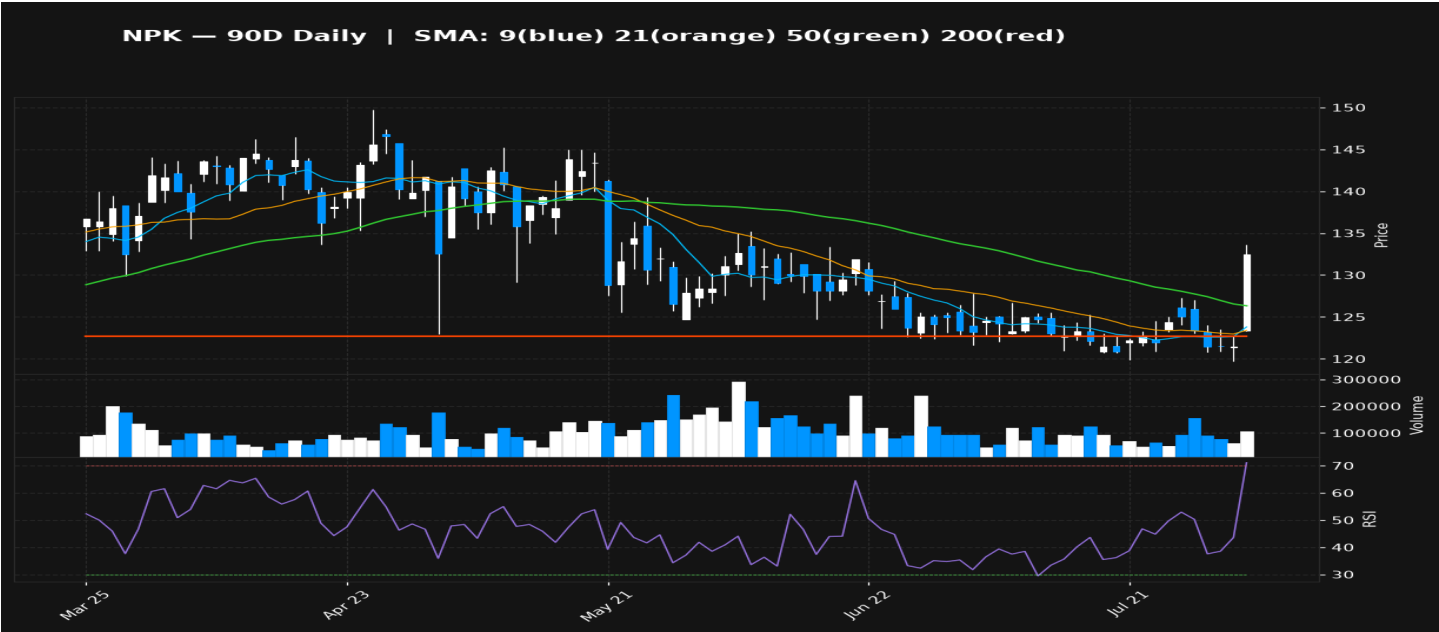
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$120 consolidation breakout level, or if defense budget appropriations or contract awards disappoint.

ANALYSIS

Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY is -5.2 (underperforming), and RS line is NOT at new high - this is not a market leader despite the defense tailwind. The next earnings are 81 days away, leaving a long gap without a near-term catalyst. However, the extreme volume (8.71x), tight float (4.8M), and defense sector tailwind earn it a B grade as a speculative position. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$132.50 on vol >8.7x of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 8.71x



BXC

Bluelinx Holdings Inc.

\$57.68

+6.38%

RS vs SPY: +13.3%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.5B Cap | 6M Float

Industrial Distribution | Theme: Building Products Distribution | 52W Hi: 66% | Base Tight: 1.9 | Vol: 2.30x | RS/SPY: +13.3% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 1D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$57.68
Day Change	+6.38%
Mkt Cap	\$0.45B
Float	6M sh
RS vs SPY	+13.3%
52W Hi Prox	66%
Base Tight	1.9
Vol vs Avg	2.30x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Pre-earnings positioning driving breakout (earnings tomorrow, August 4). Forward catalyst (High impact): tomorrow's print will test whether housing and non-residential construction demand is stabilizing and whether the company can maintain gross margins in a softening lumber market.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Bluelinx distributes building products (lumber, panels, engineered wood, specialty materials) to dealers and builders. A cyclical play on residential and commercial construction activity.

FACTOR & THEME

Housing and construction markets are mixed - residential softening on higher rates, but non-residential (data centers, industrial) remains solid. The tailwind is moderating, not accelerating.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$57.68 on vol >2.3x of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume at 2.3x average is modest, suggesting pre-earnings positioning rather than institutional accumulation. RS line is NOT at new high, and RS vs SPY of +13.3 is mediocre - this is not a leader. Float is very tight at 6.4M, amplifying moves. No insider buying in the last 90 days.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 1D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Earnings scheduled for August 4 (tomorrow). Consensus not available in this feed. BXC is a volatile, cyclical printer - the market is positioning for a potential beat, but the risk of a miss is meaningful given housing headwinds.

KEY RISK

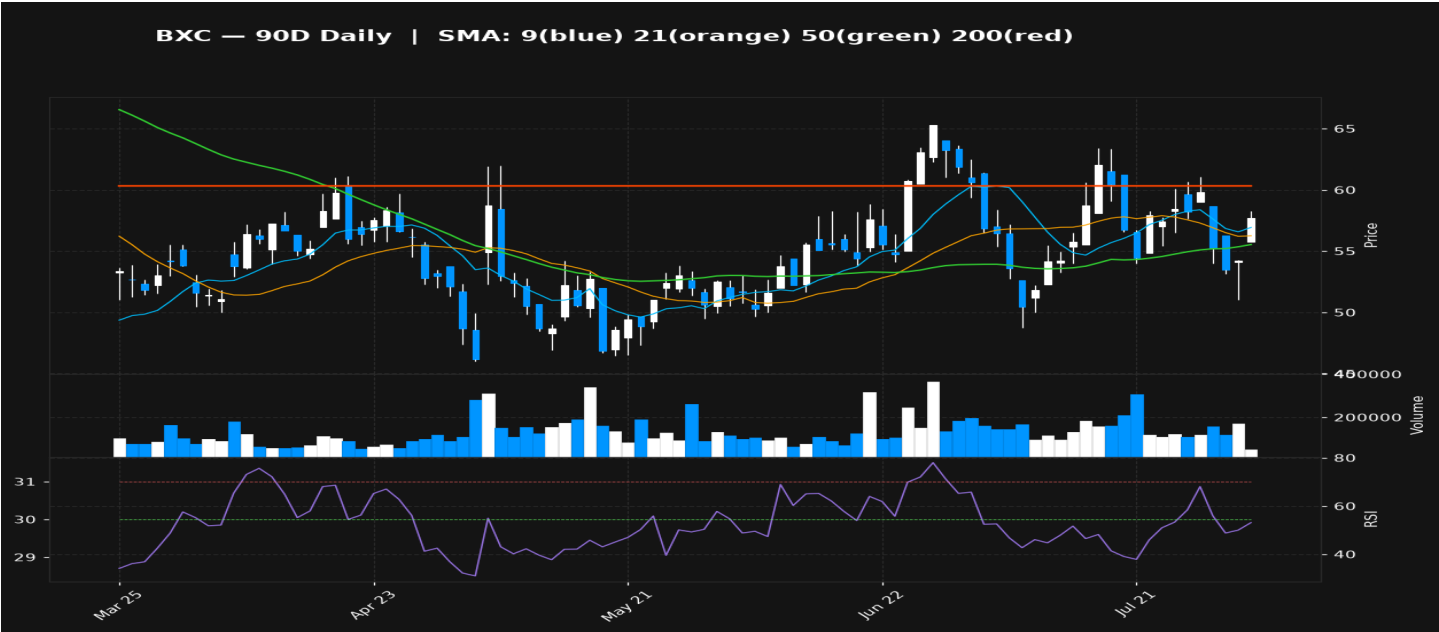
Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$54 consolidation low, or if tomorrow's earnings disappoint on volume or margin.

ANALYSIS

Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line is NOT at new high, prox_52w is only 65.6 (far from breakout zone), and RS vs SPY of +13.3 is weak. The base_tight of 1.9 is solid, but this is a pre-earnings speculation trade, not a durable breakout. The tight float (6.4M) creates binary risk. Earnings tomorrow are the sole catalyst; no forward path beyond that. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$57.68 on vol >2.3x of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.30x



LIFE

Ethos Technologies Inc.

\$22.35

+9.45%

RS vs SPY: +9.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.1B Cap | 30M Float

Insurance Brokers | Theme: InsurTech | 52W Hi: 69% | Base Tight: 2.74 | Vol: 4.06x | RS/SPY: +9.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$22.35
Day Change	+9.45%
Mkt Cap	\$2.12B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+9.5%
52W Hi Prox	69%
Base Tight	2.74
Vol vs Avg	4.06x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Earnings beat today driving 9.5% surge, likely on strong policy sales and improved unit economics in its direct-to-consumer life insurance platform. Forward catalyst (Medium impact): next earnings (likely November) will test whether customer acquisition costs are sustainable and whether the company can achieve profitability at scale.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Ethos (formerly operating under the ticker LIFE) is an InsurTech platform offering simplified, digital-first life insurance underwriting. The company targets younger, underinsured demographics with a technology-driven, low-friction application process.

FACTOR & THEME

InsurTech and digital insurance distribution are moderate tailwinds, but the category is crowded and capital-intensive. LIFE's RS of +9.5 vs SPY is weak, suggesting it's not a market leader.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$22.35 on vol >4.0x of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume at 4.06x average indicates institutional participation on the earnings beat. RS line is NOT at new high, and prox_52w of 68.8 is far from breakout territory - this is an early-stage recovery, not a breakout. Float of 29.8M is moderate. No insider buying in the last 90 days.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS TODAY

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Just reported today - consensus EPS/revenue not available in this feed. The 9.5% gap-up suggests a beat, but the stock is still 31% below its 52W high, indicating the market remains skeptical of the long-term model.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalidates on a close back below the \$20.50 prior resistance level, or if next earnings reveals customer acquisition cost inflation or churn deterioration.

ANALYSIS

Strongest disconfirming evidence: prox_52w of 68.8 and RS line NOT at new high - this is not a breakout, it's a relief rally from deeply oversold levels. The RS of +9.5 is weak, and the InsurTech theme is not accelerating. However, the base_tight of 2.74 is solid, and the earnings beat today + sector tailwind (Financials +1.8% this week) earn it a B grade as a watch for follow-through. Conviction: Low.

Signal: Close above \$22.35 on vol >4.0x of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 4.06x

